son of a liberal father, a former Austrian imperial teacher, and an ethnic-German mother. He managed to survive World War II but he was unhappy about the kind of liberty that Yugoslav Communists were able to deliver and, after a brief spell in prison, he fled the country. With his gift for languages he made his way through the displaced persons' camp in Austria to the UK. There he went through a number of jobs before he managed to settle at the BBC Slovenian service, finished a degree in economics (to add to the one in law he brought with him from home), and began what was to be a remarkable career in journalism. He toured the Communist world (described in *Living with Communism*, published in 1966 under the pseudonym of Anthony Silvester), but then he dedicated himself to Africa, which he knew inside out. Yet he never lost interest in Yugoslavia and Slovenia.

Karl was a law student, with a great interest in economics and international affairs, when World War II started. Two of his classmates at Ljubljana University at the time were men whose lives would continue to be intertwined with his in the future – Ljubo Sirc, the son of a wealthy businessman, and Aleksander Bajt, a former altar boy. Ljubo too ended up in the UK soon after the war, where he worked his way up to become a university professor in Glasgow. Another liberal but also a Yugoslav patriot, he was at first a firm believer in the idea of Tito's resistance movement which he joined. Yet this did not spare his father a death sentence, following a notorious show trial soon after the Communists came to power, and he himself narrowly escaped the same fate. Years later, he established in London the Centre for Research into Communist Economies, an academic think-tank researching the Communist economic experiment at a time when many Western academics seriously thought that it had something to offer. Ljubo wanted to warn them that this was not true.

Aleksander Bajt followed a different path. He came from a deeply religious family. So Karl was enormously surprised when, one morning after the war, he bumped into Aleksander, wearing the *partisan* uniform with the red star on his hat, and speaking passionately about the new world order that was being established in the country. According to Karl's later accounts, this meeting finally convinced Karl to leave the new Yugoslavia. Or, as he put it in his book, he left because he was 'unable to enjoy life in a closely regimented society'.